State: 1526–1750, eds, Muzaffar Alam and Sanjay Subrahmanyam (Oxford University Press, 1998).
. Harbans Mukhia, *The Mughals of India* (Blackwell Publishing, 2004; Indian reprint by Wiley India, 2018).
. 'The Happy Sayings of His Majesty', in Abu'l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 3, trans. Col. H.S. Jarrett (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).
. Abu'l Fazl, *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl* (completed by Inayatullah), vol. 3, trans. Henry Beveridge (First published 1902–1939; Low Price Publications, 2017).
. Ibid.
. Ibid.
. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.
. There were twenty-six types of coins during Akbar's rule, all of which Abul Fazl describes in the *Ain-i-Akbari*. Most commonly used among them were the gold mohur, silver rupee and copper dam. See Abu'l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1, trans. H. Blochmann (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3. The symbolic present of coins to the nobility was followed by a great distribution, 'handful by handful, and skirt by skirt' to the gathered crowd.
. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 5, trans. W.M. Thackston (Murty Classical Library of India, Harvard University Press, 2019).
. On earrings as a sign of enslavement, Annemarie Schimmel writes, 'the Persian expression *halqa be-gush*, "ring in the ear", means "slave"'. See Annemarie Schimmel, *The Empire of the Great Mughals: History, Art and Culture* (Reaktion Books, 2004, reprinted in 2010).
. Nizamuddin Ahmad, 'Tabakat-i Akbari', in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, trans. H.M. Elliot, vol. 5 (Trübner and Co., 1873).
. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.
. Ibid.
. Ibid.
. Ibid. Badauni quotes the whole mahzar in his book.
. Translator's note in Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston.
. Iqtidar Alam Khan, 'The Nobility under Akbar and the Development of His Religious Policy, 1560–80', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain and Ireland*, no. 1/2, April 1968.
. Much as, one might say, Henry VIII declared himself Supreme Head of the Church of England a half-century earlier.
. Mukhia, *The Mughals of India*.
. As for the Adam under consideration, he was 'tall, wheaten in colour', died in India, and was buried in Sri Lanka. See Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 1, trans. W.M. Thackston.
. Richard M. Eaton, *India in the Persianate Age: 1000–1765* (Allen Lane, 2019). This paragraph is extracted, with some modification, from an article I wrote for *The Hindu Businessline*, 'Between bread and empire', published 8 May 2020.
. This last phrase from Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston.
. Ibid.
. Ibid.
. Corrine Lefèvre, 'In the Name of the Fathers: Mughal Genealogical Strategies from Babur to Shah Jahan', *Religions of South Asia*, vol. 5, no. 1/2, 2011.
. Stephen F. Dale, *The Muslim Empires of the Ottomans, Safavids, and Mughals* (Cambridge University Press, 2010).
. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 1, trans. W.M. Thackston.
. The trip was no reassurance whatsoever to Badauni and his friends. '[S]ensible people smiled,' writes the unhappy historian, 'and said, "It was strange that His Majesty should have such a faith in